

MSC ELSA 3 — floating debris & pellet drift

As of 30 May, 14:00 IST · Prepared by DriftSight · prototype

Summary. 4 satellite passes processed since the sinking on 25 May 2025 (2 usable, 2 clouded). DriftSight has flagged 7 candidate debris patches; 2 are confirmed because they re-appeared where the currents predicted, and no look-alikes have been rejected yet. The pellet forecast puts 86% of the simulated nurdles ashore by this time.

2	0	86%	2
confirmed debris patches	look-alikes rejected	pellets ashore (forecast)	high-priority zones

TRACKED PATCHES

Patch	First seen	Area	Confidence	Status
Patch A	27 May, 11:00 IST	3,300 m ²	92%	confirmed
Patch B	27 May, 11:00 IST	300 m ²	76%	watch
Patch C	27 May, 11:00 IST	3,200 m ²	94%	confirmed
Patch D	30 May, 11:00 IST	400 m ²	55%	watch

PELLET LANDFALL OUTLOOK

Thiruvananthapuram 70% (first 27 May) · Kanyakumari 16% (first 29 May) · Kollam 2% (first 27 May) · Ramanathapuram 0% (first 7 Jun). Forecast first arrival at Kanyakumari 29 May, 04:00 IST, consistent with the 30 May beach survey that rated pellet pollution “Very High”.

PRIORITY ACTIONS

- HIGH** — Kanyakumari coast (8.211°N 77.205°E): Beach survey and manual pellet collection; alert fishing villages. Nearest harbour Colachel.
- HIGH** — Patch A (at sea) (8.038°N 77.366°E): Boat verification, then boom / skimmer recovery if confirmed. Nearest harbour Colachel.
- MEDIUM** — Patch C (at sea) (8.133°N 76.924°E): Boat verification, then boom / skimmer recovery if confirmed. Nearest harbour Vizhinjam.
- LOW** — Thiruvananthapuram coast (8.494°N 76.899°E): Beach survey and manual pellet collection; alert fishing villages. Nearest harbour Vizhinjam.

MISSIONS

No missions created yet.

DATA & METHOD

Detection: per-pixel classifier on Sentinel-2 bands with FDI/NDVI. Tracking: ensemble particle drift with Bayesian confirmation at each pass. Prototype uses synthetic imagery and a synthetic monsoon circulation; production uses Sentinel-2/Landsat/Sentinel-1, INCOIS/CMEMS currents and ERA5 winds.

Prototype. Detection imagery and ocean fields in this report are simulated; no figure here is a measurement. Production sources: Sentinel-2 / Landsat / Sentinel-1 imagery, INCOIS and CMEMS currents, ERA5 winds.